

Photograph by ISHITA SITWALA



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The Alchemy of Brass

VEERAM SHAH | DESIGN NI DUKAAN

For Veeram Shah, founder and principal architect, Design ni Dukaan, a kitchen must be as unique as the family's daily routine. In this 250 sq ft kitchen in Navsari, Gujarat the design team turned to experimental chemistry to create a one-of-a-kind visual identity. The standout feature is the pink brass cabinetry. "A key highlight of the space is the use of an in-house developed brass patina technique," says Veeram. By applying salt to brass sheets and leaving them in the studio backyard overnight, aided by a serendipitous rain shower, the team developed a natural patina with unexpected soft pink undertones. This tactile finish adds a layer of living history to the space.



Functionally, the kitchen tackles the challenge of Vaastu-inspired layouts. To ensure the hob remained in the east without disrupting the flow, Veeram introduced a central island. This sculptural element allows for multi-sided access, proving that cultural requirements can be the catalyst for better design rather than a constraint.



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